to use the debugger, you can already see that it’s a useful tool.

The future will include JavaScript, but it’s not all JavaScript. Every day there are more languages that compile to JavaScript. Source maps go just that little bit further to opening up the JavaScript language to embrace them.

13.5. Summary

In this chapter you looked at the language ecosystem around CoffeeScript. Specifically, you saw how CoffeeScript not only benefits from advancements in the ECMA-Script specification but also contributes to them. Your deeper understanding of both current and future language features will ultimately make you a better CoffeeScript programmer.

As a CoffeeScript programmer, you also need tools like source maps. Support for those is emerging rapidly on runtimes, so by starting today you’ll be prepared for tomorrow (which will arrive sooner than you think). Regardless of whether you’re ultimately writing JavaScript, CoffeeScript, or a mixture of both, you’ll be better off for learning what the future holds. After all, learning and using are, to borrow a phrase from Scruffy’s high school English teacher, inexorably intertwined.